

Filtered vs Structured Water

What is actually different — including which part of it is settled and which part is not.

I wrote this because I could not find it. Almost everything published about water devices comes in one of two flavours: it is selling you something, and every claim arrives at the same level of confidence; or it dismisses the whole category without separating the well-understood parts from the speculative ones.

Both leave you unable to evaluate anything. This is the version that marks the difference.

What this document is. An explanation of a distinction. It does not recommend a product, it does not tell you what to buy, and it does not claim any device does anything to your health. If you finish it having decided none of this is for you, it worked.

Filtration: what it is

Filtration **removes things**. Water passes through a medium, and the medium traps or binds particular contaminants — sediment, chlorine, certain metals, certain organic compounds — depending on what the medium is made of.

Different media catch different things. Activated carbon works by adsorption, holding molecules on a very large internal surface area. A mechanical filter works by pore size, physically excluding anything larger than its openings. Reverse osmosis pushes water through a membrane that most dissolved substances cannot follow it through.

All of this is ordinary engineering, and it is verifiable in the most ordinary way: measure what was in the water before, measure what is in it after. That is why nobody argues about it. The disagreements in filtration are practical ones — which medium for which contaminant, at what flow rate, at what cost, and how often it must be replaced before it stops working.

Structuring: a different kind of claim

Here the ground changes, and I want to be exact about how.

Structured water devices **do not claim to remove anything**. The proposition is that the *arrangement* of the water can be altered — that water passed through a particular geometry comes out organised differently than it went in, while containing exactly the same molecules.

Notice that this is a different *type* of statement, not merely a bolder one. Filtration says: something was present and now it is not. That is testable by measurement. Structuring says: nothing was added or removed, but the state is different. Demonstrating that is a far harder problem, and it is exactly where the disagreement lives.

	FILTRATION	STRUCTURING
What it claims to change	What is in the water	How the water is arranged
How you would test it	Measure contaminants before and after	Contested — there is no agreed measurement
Mechanism	Adsorption, exclusion by pore size, membrane separation	Proposed: geometry acting on molecular arrangement
Status	Settled engineering	Contested
Maintenance	Media are consumed and must be replaced	Typically no consumable, no power

Stated plainly, because it is the whole point of the document: filtration is settled. Structuring is contested. I own a structuring device and I find the idea interesting — and neither of those facts makes it settled. Anybody presenting the two to you at the same confidence level is either not paying attention or hoping that you are not.

Why I am telling you this against my own interest

Two reasons. The first is that it is true.

The second is that I trained as a physician, and a physician who lends his credentials to a claim that has not earned them is doing the most damaging thing available to him. My training is a reason to think I know what evidence looks like. It is **not** a reason to believe a device does anything, and I will not use it that way.

The same applies to stories. People say a great many things about how they feel after using these devices. Those accounts are not evidence of effect — and that is not a legal technicality, it is the actual reason careful people run trials instead of collecting anecdotes. Human beings feel better for many reasons and cannot tell from the inside which one is operating.

The questions worth asking anybody who sells you either

What specifically does this remove or change, and how would that be measured?

A good answer is concrete. A vague one, or an answer about how you will feel, is not an answer to this question.

Is the mechanism you are describing settled, or is it a proposal?

Both are legitimate answers. Only one of them is legitimate to give without saying which.

What is the device physically made of, and why that construction?

Somebody who built or understands the thing can answer this immediately.

What will you not claim about it?

The most useful question in the entire category. The answer tells you more about the seller than the first three combined.

Where I stand

This is a preventive orientation and it does not compete with the medical system. Nothing here is intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent anything, and nothing here replaces care from your own physician. Whatever you decide about any of it, never neglect your traditional medical treatment.

My goal is to inform, not to push. If you have got to the end of this and concluded the structuring claim is not for you, that is a good outcome — it means I described the situation honestly rather than persuasively.

And if it has raised more questions, bring them. Sceptical ones are the best kind, and a person who has already decided is not really curious.

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